

PLAYING IN 7/4

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #177

One of the ways jazz musicians have pushed the music ahead in the past fifty or sixty years is playing in "odd" time signatures. Dave Brubek and Paul Desmond were famous for *Take Five* and the many other songs they wrote and played in 5/4, 9/8 and more. Not only are odd time signatures part of the music these days, they are also a great way to get stronger with our foundational rhythmic sense, and to hone our rhythmic abilities.

#1 - Two measures of 4/4



#2 - One measure of 7/4



#3 - The 7/4 Parent Rhythm or Clave



The trick to sounding confident and natural in 7/4 (or any odd time signature) is found in playing "inside the Clave" or "inside the Parent Rhythm." If you are comfortable with improvising in 4/4, and good with soloing in 3/4, then you have a great head start with sounding good in 7/4. The next step is to work on playing melodies, altered to fit the new 7/4 Clave/Parent Rhythm.

#4 - All The Things You Are in 7/4

